



CRAVINGS.

THE IAAJ GUIDE SERIES

It was never weak willpower. It was a signal you can finally read.

UNDERSTANDING HUNGER, ENDING GUILT
FOUNDED 2017 · 5,000+ CLIENTS

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SECTION 01

It was never weak willpower.

You have blamed yourself for years. For the 4 PM sugar hunt. For the packet of biscuits that vanished before you noticed. For the way the evening always seems to undo the day.

Here is the truth. A craving is not a character flaw. It is a message. Your body is telling you something is off, low blood sugar, poor sleep, too little food, or stress it can't shake.

Willpower was never the answer, because willpower was never the problem. Once you learn to read the signal, you stop fighting yourself and start fixing the cause.

"You are not failing the diet. The diet is failing to feed you properly."

SECTION 02

The four cravings you know too well.

They arrive at the same times, in the same way. See which of these is yours.



The afternoon sugar hunt

Around 3 or 4 PM, you would do anything for something sweet.



The night-time raid

Perfect all day. Then the kitchen calls after dinner and won't stop.



The stress eat

A hard day, and suddenly you are eating without even deciding to.



The "I've ruined it" spiral

One slip, and the whole day feels lost, so you keep going.

None of these are about weakness. Each one has a cause. And a cause can be fixed.

SECTION 03

Why cravings really happen.

Five real drivers. Notice that not one of them is "you have no discipline."



Blood sugar crashes

A carb-heavy meal spikes then drops your sugar. The crash screams for more sugar.



You ate too little

Under-eating during the day guarantees a body that demands it all back at night.



Poor sleep

One bad night raises your hunger hormones the next day. You are hungrier, for worse food.



Stress and low mood

Stress drives you toward sugar and fat specifically. It is chemistry, not comfort-seeking.



Thirst in disguise

Mild dehydration often reads as hunger. You reach for food when you needed water.

SECTION 04

Read the craving, find the fix.

Next time it hits, run through these questions before you reach for food.

ASK When did I last eat protein?

If it has been hours, or the last meal was mostly carbs, this is a blood sugar craving. Eat protein, not sugar.

ASK Did I eat enough today?

If you skipped or under-ate, your body is simply asking for the fuel it is owed. Feed it a real meal.

ASK How did I sleep?

A rough night means today's hunger is exaggerated. Know it, and don't trust every signal at face value.

ASK Am I actually stressed, not hungry?

If a feeling triggered it, food won't fix the feeling. Breathe, walk, or step away first.

ASK Have I had water?

Drink a glass, wait ten minutes. Real hunger stays. Thirst fades.

SECTION 05

Build a body that doesn't crave.

The goal is not to resist cravings with sheer force. It is to build days where they barely show up.



Anchor every meal with protein

The single biggest lever. It steadies blood sugar so the crash never comes.



Eat enough during the day

Stop under-eating. A well-fed day is the only real defence against a raided night.



Add fibre and fat

Vegetables and healthy fats slow digestion and keep you full for longer.



Protect your sleep

Fix sleep and you fix tomorrow's hunger before it starts. It is that direct.



Stay ahead on water

Steady hydration removes a whole category of false cravings.

SECTION 06

When it hits anyway.

Some cravings still come. Here is how to handle them without guilt or a spiral.

- 1 **Pause for ten minutes**
Cravings peak and pass. Set a timer. Most fade before it rings.

- 2 **Eat protein first**
If you are still hungry after ten minutes, have something with protein before anything sweet.

- 3 **Have the thing, on a plate**
If you truly want it, portion it out and enjoy it slowly. Never eat from the packet.

- 4 **Never let one become five**
One biscuit is one biscuit. The guilt spiral is what turns it into the whole packet.

- 5 **Move on immediately**
Return to normal at the very next meal. No punishment, no compensating.

One craving, satisfied calmly, is nothing. The guilt afterward is what does the damage.

WHERE TO FROM HERE

Stop fighting. Start reading.

For years you were told cravings meant you were weak. You were never weak. You were under-fed, under-slept, and stressed, and your body did exactly what bodies do.

Once your days are built right, protein anchored, enough food, good sleep, steady water, the cravings quiet down on their own. Not through willpower. Through biology working in your favour.

Start with one meal tomorrow. Anchor it with protein and notice how the afternoon feels different.

And if you want a plan that ends the cravings at the root, built around your body, we're here when you're ready.

This guide is for education and lifestyle support, not medical advice. If cravings feel compulsive or are tied to your relationship with food in a way that worries you, please speak to a qualified professional. There is real support available, and no shame in seeking it.